Holding Symbol

The **Holding Symbol** file contains the library's list of holding symbols and the actions associated with each symbol. Holding symbols are used to generate call numbers and locations when downloading bibliographic records from OCLC, RLIN, and other sources. Innovative sets a trigger in the load tables that specifies which MARC field in downloaded records contains the holding symbol (usually the 049 field).

The **Holding Symbol** file can be used to:

- Specify the LOCATION code for the record
- Specify a list of MARC fields from which to extract the call number
- Determine a thesaurus for subject heading fields, based on the second indicator value for MARC **6XX** fields
- Select specific subject heading fields (for example, for a particular holding library code, the site may want to retain medical subject headings only)
- Set specific fixed-length fields based on the holding library

When a record is downloaded, the system checks the record for the presence of the field designated by the load table trigger. If the field data matches one of the holding symbols in the Holding Symbol file, the action associated with that holding symbol is performed. For example, all downloaded records with the holding symbol **SLIB** can automatically be assigned the LOCATION code **SCI**.

If a downloaded record does not contain a holding symbol field or the data in that field does not match a holding symbol in the **Holding Symbol** file, the first entry in the file dictates the default action. (See the Sample Default Entry below.)

Using Holdings Symbols

If your library has never used holding symbols, contact Innovative to set up this feature.

Data Elements

Each entry in the **Holding Symbol** file consists of the following elements:

Element Name	Description
HOLDING SYMBOL	An alphabetic code designating the holding library or collection within a library. This is usually four characters, but can be as long as eleven characters. The system compares this code to the data in the designated field in downloaded records and, if it matches, the action specified in the entry's elements is performed.
BRANCH NUMBER	**UNUSED** Usually set to '**0**'.
BRANCH CODE	LOCATION code to which the Holding Symbol is converted.
VALID IND 2 FOR 6XX	Up to five second indicator values for 6xx fields, indicating which 6xx fields should be retained in the downloaded record. Each indicator value is entered without spaces or other punctuation (e.g., **80** means that 6xx fields with either **8** or **0** in the second indicator are retained). If there are multiple holding symbols in the record, the first holding symbol that matches an entry in the Holding Symbol file determines the retention of 6xx fields from the record.

Special values for this element are:

B or **b** blank 2nd indicator

+ all `6xx` fields regardless of indicator 2 value

CALL # PRIOR ORDER Specifies the order in which MARC Call Number fields in the downloaded record are evaluated for inclusion in the Innovative record. MARC field tags can include subfield specifiers in the form **MARCtag/SubfieldList** (e.g., **090/ab**). A maximum of 31 characters can be entered into this element. The system will convert the data in the first MARC field it encounters from this list.

For example, if the list is:

```
099,090/ab,050/ab
```

and the record has no `099`, but has an `090` field, the data from the `090` field's `$a` and `$b` subfields will be used as the call number in the Innovative record. If the record also has an `050` field, it is not used, since the `090` has priority.

PRE STAMP This feature is primarily used by RLIN sites. The data in this field acts as an "automatic stamp," placed before or after the manual stamp that is keyed in brackets before the `049` field. The ordering of this automatic stamp (before or after the manual stamp) is determined by a trigger that appears in the load tables. For multiple holding symbols, the pre-stamp of the first holding symbol is used for all others in the record. The maximum length of this automatic stamp is twenty-five characters.

> Inserting pre-stamps and post-stamps can seriously affect indexing and WebPAC display. If your library has not previously entered pre-stamps and post-stamps, staff should carefully consider the implications of adding these.

POST STAMP Secondary automatic stamp. See the description of the **PRE STAMP** element.

FIX NUMBER This feature is primarily used by RLIN sites. Specifies the line number of a fixed-length field in the fixed-length fields file. You can determine the number of a particular fixed length field by viewing the list displayed in the Long names for fixed length fields menu. The specified field is set to the value in the **FIX VALUE** element. If this feature is not used for a particular entry, set its value to **0**.

FIX VALUE Value to which the fixed-length field specified in the **FIX NUMBER** element is to be set.

Editing the Holding Symbol File

1. In the **Select file** drop-down menu of the **ASAA** function, choose **Holding Symbol** and then **Select**.
2. Double-click the holding symbol you want to edit, or to create a new holding symbol, choose the **Append** or **Insert** tool.
3. Enter the holding symbol parameters in the Edit window, and choose **OK**.
4. Select the **Save** tool to save your changes.

For more information on editing this file, see Editing Entries.

Sample Holdings Symbol File Entries

OCLC Library

HOLDING SYMBOL	LAFR
BRANCH NUMBER	0
BRANCH CODE	archv
VALID IND FOR 2ND 6XX	+
CALL # PRIOR ORDER	099,090,082
PRE STAMP	
POST STAMP	
FIX NUMBER	0
FIX VALUE	

RLIN Library

HOLDING SYMBOL	MOMI
BRANCH NUMBER	0
BRANCH CODE	malw
VALID IND FOR 2ND 6XX	0
CALL # PRIOR ORDER	950/d,090/ab
PRE STAMP	
POST STAMP	LAW
FIX NUMBER	0
FIX VALUE	

RLIN Library

HOLDING SYMBOL	OOMI
BRANCH NUMBER	0
BRANCH CODE	main
VALID IND FOR 2ND 6XX	0
CALL # PRIOR ORDER	950/d,090/ab
PRE STAMP	
POST STAMP	
FIX NUMBER	31
FIX VALUE	a

Example of a default entry
(See Notes below)

HOLDING SYMBOL	AAAA
BRANCH NUMBER	0
BRANCH CODE	zzzzz
VALID IND FOR 2ND 6XX	b0
CALL # PRIOR ORDER	050,090,099
PRE STAMP	
POST STAMP	
FIX NUMBER	0
FIX VALUE	

Notes on the Default Entry

- The default entry must be the first entry in the **Holding Symbol** file. It "catches" items without a holding symbol or with an incorrect one.
- You can use a LOCATION (BRANCH) code other than **zzzzz** as the default location.

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